



CollegePro Science

This lecturer delivers

CollegePro Science is a set of CDs spanning five subjects—general chemistry, bio-chemistry, molecular cell biology, microbiology and genetics. There is substantial information on almost every sub-topic within these subjects you can think of.

A glossary helps you locate the meaning of any term or phrase that you come across while browsing through the material. A good study aid at the college level, this is a well-designed, well-laid out set.

Ease of navigation is probably the best aspect of this set. You can navigate by subject, search by keyword, and view diagrams via hyperlinks. In fact, each CD is a large network of hyperlinks. You're never lost—there are clear paths to get you back to where you came from—and there are always related subjects dis-

played to prompt you to go deeper.

However, don't expect this to be the Encyclopaedia Britannica of all five subjects. Despite the additional information across various areas, the overall coverage is not too comprehensive.

The topics are dealt with to the extent of detail that the average college student requires. This marks the set as meant specifically for students—if you're not a student, and you're interested in, say, bio-chem-

istry, you might find the coverage a little shallow.

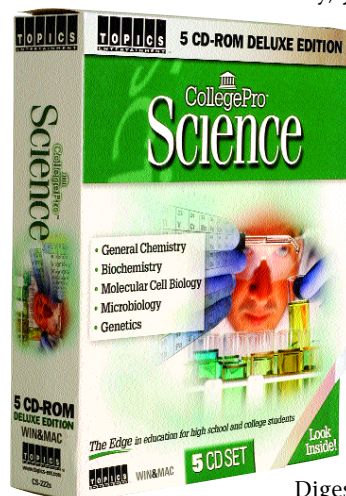
This software comes in handy for a student when it comes to reviewing matter that has been covered in class. Pick up a topic, click, browse, revise. Much better than rummaging through books to find that little piece of information you are looking for. And, there will be a structure to your revision (or first reading).

One sore point may be that the software might not work very well for students who are accustomed to using

Digests for study as well as revision.

Overall though, CollegePro Science is definitely worth Rs 1,995.

RAM MOHAN RAO



Publisher: Topics Entertainment ■ **System Requirements:** Pentium Processor, Windows 95, 12 MB RAM, 4X CD-ROM drive, sound card
Phone: (425)656-3621 ■ **E-mail:** info@topics-ent.com ■ **Web site:** www.topics-ent.com ■ **Price:** Rs 1,350
Rating: ★★★★★



SAMS Teach Yourself Internet and Web Basics: All in One

Wading through the Internet

The cover boasts that the book entails Internet basics, Web browsing, e-mail and chat, fun and games, virii and hackers and Web pages. A look inside, however, throws up a few discrepancies.

A major part of the book is devoted to a tutorial on setting up a small Web site. It is quite comprehensive as a hands-on guide to someone who is not too Internet-savvy and wants to learn the basics of Web authoring—probably to set up a small personal Web site. The book makes good reading for someone simply interested in browsing through the lucidly written guide explaining software like Netscape Composer and Paint Shop Pro.

The first section of the book deals only with established names, like Internet Explorer and Google. There is a sporadic

mention of Netscape, chiefly the e-mail program that comes bundled with it.

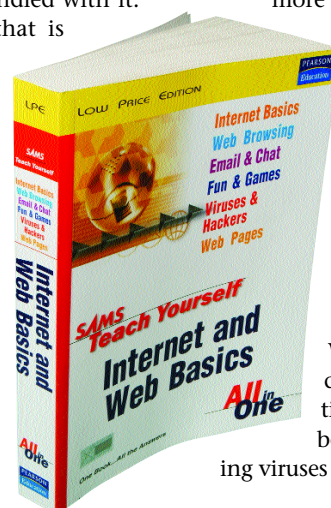
However, the section that is meant for the Internet rookie gives a thorough run through of Windows-based applications, so the orientation is with the stuff that comes bundled with Windows.

On the other hand, the section on site-building makes very little mention of either Microsoft Front Page or Dreamweaver. It talks at length about Netscape Composer, but not

Front Page Express, which is probably the more widely available of the two!

The book is useful for elderly people; perhaps for parents desperate to keep up with their techno-savvy kids. It does contain lots of simple, conversational tips on how to control and filter offensive content off the Internet. It puts the reader on guard over tackling virii, while furnishing tips on trading over the Net. What the book lacks, though, is depth. The small, shallow section on Internet security too, belies the bold red fonts declaring viruses and hackers on the cover.

SUPROTIP GHOSH



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